

Report: Pre Professional/ Professional Practice

Facultad de Ingeniería y Ciencias Aplicadas,
Universidad de los Andes

Sofía Castelli
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*Empresas SB Preunic.
Preunic is a retail chain under Empresas SB, specializing in beauty, personal care and household products, with a strong focus on customers satisfaction.*

Abstract

Preunic, a subsidiary of Empresas SB, is a leading beauty, personal care, and household products retailer in Chile, with a strong market presence across physical store and online platforms. The company is committed to customer satisfaction, competitive pricing, and organizational efficiency, leveraging Business Intelligence tools to optimize its decision-making processes.

During my internship in the BI department, I was responsible for collecting, validating, analyzing, and visualizing data, which contributed to strategic decision-making within the organization. My main tasks included developing interactive dashboards in Qlik, optimizing SQL queries, generating reports for various departments, and conducting market and competitor analysis. Additionally, I collaborated with marketing, sales, and finance teams, ensuring that data-driven insights aligned with business objectives. Among the most significant challenges I faced was designing a product elasticity dashboard, which required analyzing how products performed within Preunic and the broader market. Another key challenge was optimizing the "Días de Alcance" query, which calculated stock coverage and provided essential inventory planning insights.

Despite facing challenges related to data validation, panel usability, and market data inconsistencies, I successfully addressed them through iterative improvements, methodological refinements, and stakeholder-driven adjustments. These experiences allowed me to enhance my technical proficiency in SQL, data visualization, and analytical problem-solving, while also strengthening my ability to collaborate and adapt within a dynamic business environment. This internship improved my technical skills and helped me understand strategic decision-making. I also learned to collaborate effectively and the importance of continuous learning—skills that will be key in my career.

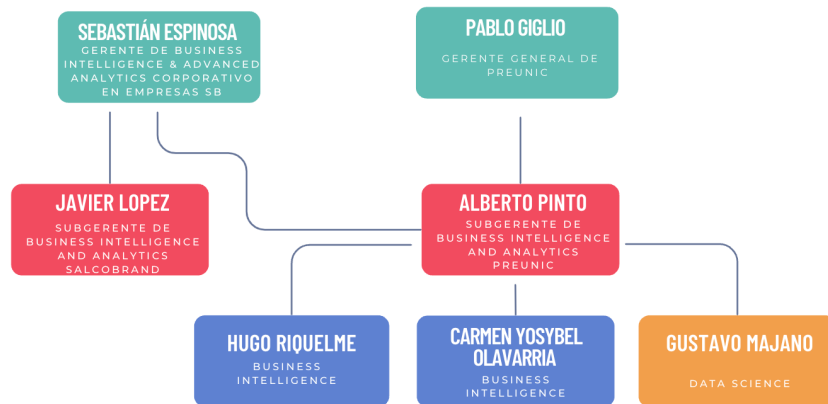
1. Introduction

1.1 Company Description

Preunic is one of Chile's top retailers, specializing in beauty, personal care, and household essentials. It also offers toys and stationery. With a history spanning over 70 years, the company has established a strong reputation for offering affordable, high-quality products tailored to consumer needs. In 2012, Preunic became part of Empresas SB, a major holding company that also owns Salcobrand, one of Chile's largest pharmacy chains. This integration strengthened Preunic's market presence, allowing it to leverage synergies in retail, logistics, and customer experience, reinforcing its commitment to operational excellence and customer satisfaction.

Preunic's core business revolves around providing a diverse portfolio of beauty and self-care products, with a particular emphasis on women's beauty and wellness. The company offers a broad selection of cosmetics, skincare, haircare, fragrances, wellness items, home essentials, and seasonal products. To ensure accessibility and convenience, Preunic operates through both a nationwide network of over 100 physical stores and a robust e-commerce platform, catering to a wide range of customers across Chile.

With a workforce of more than 3,000 employees, Preunic is a key player in the Chilean retail industry, supported by the broader success of Empresas SB, which generates millions in annual revenue. The company maintains a strong market position, ranking among the top beauty and self-care retailers in the country.



To maintain operational efficiency and seamlessly integrate business functions, Preunic follows a structured organizational framework. The Executive Management team oversees corporate strategy, growth, and expansion, while Sales and Operations handle retail management, inventory control, and supply chain logistics. The Marketing department drives branding, customer engagement, and promotional campaigns, and Finance & Accounting ensures financial planning, revenue management, and budget allocation. The Business Intelligence team plays a crucial role in supporting data-driven decision-making, providing analytics and insights that optimize sales performance, inventory levels, and customer behavior. Meanwhile, the IT and E-Commerce division manages digital infrastructure, online sales, and system integration, enhancing the company's digital transformation strategy.

Preunic's ability to integrate retail expertise, data analytics, and customer insights has been fundamental to its steady growth and competitive edge. By leveraging technology, strategic partnerships, and market intelligence, the company continues to expand its presence, enhance customer experience, and drive innovation in the beauty and personal care sector.

1.2 Department/Area Description

The Business Intelligence area in Preunic plays a crucial role in leveraging data to support decision-making across the organization. This department is responsible for collecting, processing, analyzing, and visualizing data to provide insight that enhance business strategies and operations. By transforming raw data into actionable information, the BI team helps different department optimize their processes, improve efficiency, and adapt to market trends.

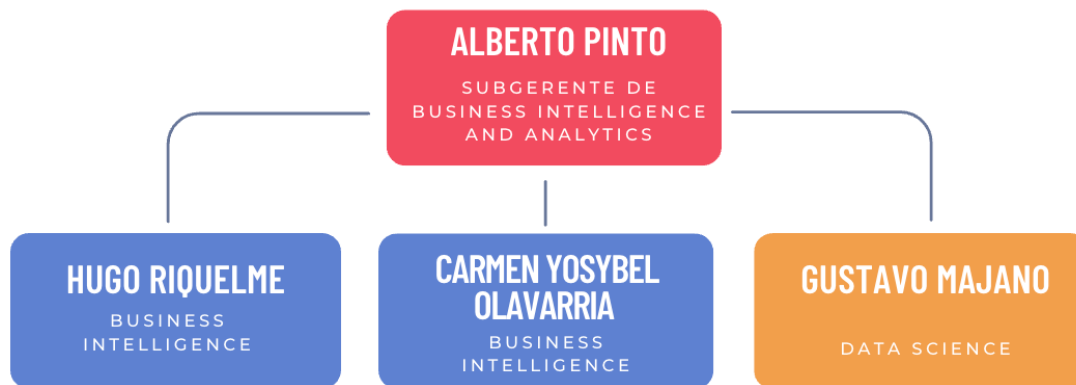
Activity Performed:

- Data collections and processing
- Data analysis and reporting
- Performance monitoring
- Market and competitor analysis
- Automation and optimizations of process
- Cross departmental support

Relationship with other areas:

The BI department serves as a strategic bridge between data and decision-making, collaborating closely with various departments to enhance business operations. It supports the Marketing Department by providing insights into customer preferences, purchasing behaviors, and campaign performance, enabling the development of data-driven strategies. In Sales and Operations, the BI team analyzes sales performance, inventory levels, and operational efficiency, ensuring effective supply chain management and demand forecasting. Additionally, it plays a crucial role in the Finance Department by delivering accurate financial reports, assisting in planning, forecasting, and profitability analysis. Lastly, the BI team works with IT and Data Management to uphold data integrity, security, and system integration, ensuring the seamless flow of information across the organization.

Organizational Structure of the BI Department



The BI department is led by Alberto Pinto, who oversees strategy implementation and ensures that the team's work aligns with Preunic's business objectives. Reporting to Alberto, Yosybel Olavarria and Hugo Riquelme handle various aspects of data processing, visualization, and automation. Additionally, Gustavo Majano works as a Data Scientist, analyzing customer behavior, sales trends, and inventory data to optimize pricing, marketing strategies, and supply chain efficiency, enabling data-driven decision-making.

Throughout my internship, I worked closely with Alberto, receiving continuous guidance on data analysis best practices, dashboard design, and visualization techniques. Their mentorship helped me develop a deeper understanding of BI's impact on business operations, strengthening both my technical and analytical skills while reinforcing the importance of data-driven decision-making.

The BI department at Preunic is a dynamic and essential part of the organization, empowering the company with valuable insights that drive efficiency, growth, and adaptability in an ever-evolving market.

2. Work Details

2.1 General Activities

During my internship at Preunic's BI department, I worked on different projects, including:

Familiarization with Tools and Training: Initially, I took time to familiarize myself with the tools and processes essential for my tasks, such as Qlik and DBeaver. Where I received training with the guidance of experience team members, to navigate these systems and understand their impact on daily operations. Which not helped me develop technical skills but also gave me a clearer picture of how everything connects within the organization. This foundation allowed me to quickly adapt and contribute meaningfully to the team.

Result Validations: On multiple occasions, I performed data validations, updates, and year over year comparisons to analyze trends and differences. This activity involved details analysis to identify and address any significant discrepancies, ensuring data accuracy and consistency. Using SQL, I was able to extract, compare, and refine data, allowing for more reliable insights and supporting better decision-making processes.

Reports and Dashboards Generation: Throughout my internship, I develop multiples reports for different areas within the organization, utilizing SQL queries to extract relevant data and using PowerPoint to present insights in a clear and comprehensive manner. Additionally, I designed and refined interactive dashboards in Qlik, incorporating charts and tables to enhance user experience and facilitate data interpretation. These dashboards were instrumental in analyzing product performance, both within Preunic and in the broader market, allowing for better decision-making and strategic planning.

During my internship, I had the opportunity to work in a collaborative and dynamic environment, interacting with professionals from different areas, both within and outside the Preunic BI team. Talking to different teams helped me understand business needs and improve my reports and dashboards so they were useful for the company.

A significant part of my work involved close collaboration with data analysts and business managers, who relied on my report and dashboards for decision-making. By working with them, I gained valuable insights into how different teams utilized data to drive strategies and optimize operations. My interactions were not limited to internal teams in BI; I also engaged with external stakeholders, such as suppliers and market analysts, when validating data related to product performance and market trends.

Additionally, I received continuous feedback from team members such as Hugo and Yosybel, who played an important role in guiding me through the technical aspects of Qlik and SQL query optimization. Their mentorship helped me refine my analytical skills and improve the efficiency of the reports and dashboards I developed.

Beyond data-related tasks, my role also involved participation in team discussions and strategy meetings daily, where I had the chance to contribute ideas and better understand the broader goals

of the company. These experiences reinforced the importance of clear communications and cross-functional collaboration in ensuring the success of business intelligence initiatives.

2.2 Most Challenge Activity

One of the most significant challenges I faced during internship was designing and optimizing interactive dashboards in Qlik. This required integrating multiple data sources, ensuring accuracy, and presenting insights in a way that was both accessible and actionable for users. The complexity lay in structuring large volumes of data efficiently while maintaining performance, usability and clarity.

Another major challenge was creating a price elasticity dashboard to analyze product performance both at Preunic and in the market. This dashboard compared internal sales trends with market behavior and incorporated "what-if" scenarios to predict future demand based on price adjustments. This analysis was crucial for pricing decisions, allowing the company to determinate whether a product was inelastic or elastic, guiding strategic pricing policies. To accomplish this, I had to revisit economic elasticity concepts, study existing data structure, craft SQL queries and design a user-friendly dashboard that effectively conveyed insights to decision-making.

Another significant project involved optimizing a complex query related to "Días de Alcance", which calculates how many days worth of stock is available and when restocking is needed. The original query was inefficient, affecting performance and accuracy. After refining the query for better execution time and precision, I integrated it into Qlik and built a new dashboard. This dashboard was critical for inventory planning, as it provided real-time insights on stock levels and purchasing needs. Given its importance, it was essential to ensure the data was 100% accurate and aligned with business expectations.

To tackle these challenges, I worked closely with Hugo, who guided me in mastering Qlik's functionalities, and Yosybel, who helped optimize SQL queries to improve efficiency. The elasticity analysis required continuous feedback and adjustments to ensure stakeholders could easily interpret the data, leading to multiple iterations where I applied user feedback to improve dashboard clarity. Similarly, for "Días de Alcance", I engaged in multiple meetings to understand the requirements and limitations of the existing query, ensuring the final dashboard met all business needs.

Throughout this process, I collaborated with cross functional teams, to align my work with business objectives. Their input was instrumental in refining my dashboards, and by engaging in ongoing discussions and iterative improvements, I was able to deliver tolls that significantly enhanced decision-making.

This experience not only strengthened my technical and analytical skills but also reinforced the importance of collaboration, adaptability, and clear communication in delivering impactful business intelligence solutions.

3. Analysis

3.1 Company Analysis

Preunic is a leading retail company in Chile, specializing in beauty, personal care, and household products. With a strong presence, the company operates both physical store and a web page platform, ensuring broad accessibility to costumers. The following is a general analysis of the organization, addressing relevant aspects such as productivity, capacity, employees, among others.

- **Productivity:**

Productivity relies heavily on data driven strategies and efficient resource management. The company leverages BI tools such as Qlik and databases to monitor and optimize key performance indicators $\dot{z}$, including sale trends, inventory levels, and customer behavior. A well-structured supply chain prevents stock shortages and overstock situations. Additionally, Preunic actively explores sustainability initiatives, such as promoting cruelty-free and eco-friendly products, aligning with emerging consumer preferences and industry trends.

- **Innovation capacity:**

Preunic demonstrates a strong commitment to innovation, integrating technology and data analytics into its business model to enhance decision-making. The company continuously improves its platform, allowing for a wider market reach and increased sales. The integration of BI tools and real-time monitoring systems optimizes operations, ensuring that strategic decisions are based on accurate, data-driven insights.

- **Human resources:**

The company employs a diverse workforce, including professionals in business intelligence, sales, marketing, operations, and customer service. The company fosters a collaborative work culture, where cross-functional teams engage in joint projects to optimize operations and improve customer satisfaction. Continuous employee development programs ensure that teams remain equipped with the necessary technical and analytical skills to contribute effectively.

Despite its strong market position, Preunic faces challenges such as intense competition, economic fluctuations, and shifting consumer behaviors. To remain competitive, the company must continue investing in innovation, expanding its digital presence, and refining data driven strategies. Additionally, opportunities for international expansion, deeper digitalization, and enhanced Business Intelligence capabilities present new avenues for long-term growth, allowing it to strengthen its market presence and adapt to evolving industry demands.

Preunic's commitment to customer satisfaction, technological integration, and employee development positions it well for sustained success. However, to maintain its competitive edge, the company must proactively adapt to market shifts, enhance operational efficiency, and leverage emerging technologies. By continuing to optimize its processes and embrace innovation, Preunic can reinforce its leadership in the Chilean retail industry while positioning itself for future expansion and long-term stability.

3.2 Work Analysis

During my internship with the Business Intelligence team at Preunic, I had the opportunity to contribute to several key activities that directly impacted the company's operations. I provided a detailed analysis of the work I performed, the outcomes it produced, the mistakes I encountered, and the measures I propose to minimize or solve these issues moving forward.

Contributions to the Organization

The BI team at Preunic is responsible for several crucial tasks aimed at optimizing business strategies and ensuring informed decision-making across various departments.

Data collection and processing: One of my primary responsibilities was ensuring the accuracy and consistency of data used by the organization. I helped extract and organize data from multiple sources, including sales, inventory, and customer transactions using utilizing queries, I was able to validate and update data, ensuring that it met the standards required for accurate reporting. This process was essential in maintaining clean, consistent, and reliable data, ensuring that key performance indicators, such as sales volume and customer preferences, were accurately represented. As a result, my work in data processing and validation contributed significantly to the integrity of reports and dashboards, leading to a clearer and more accurate understanding of business performance.

Data analysis and reporting: I contributed to the generation of reports and dashboards that summarized business performance. This included creating interactive dashboards in Qlik and PowerPoint presentations, which were shared with marketing teams and others areas. The reports I developed provided critical insights into sales trends and customer behavior, which helped teams optimize marketing strategies and sales efforts. For example, a dashboard I created for price elasticity analysis allowed the pricing team to make data-driven decisions about adjusting product prices, considering both market trends and internal sales data.

Performance monitoring: I participated in monitoring key performance indicators such as sales, customer behavior, and product performance. This data was essential for informing operational decisions assessing the effectiveness of ongoing strategies. By analyzing and visualizing this data, I helped the team better understand trends and performance patterns, which led to more informed decisions regarding inventory management, promotional campaigns, and customer engagement strategies.

Market and competitor analysis: Another critical aspect of my work involved comparing Preunic's performance with broader market trends and competitors. I worked closely with the marketing and sales teams to generate reports that identified potential areas for improvement and allowed us to adapt our strategies accordingly. This analysis helped Preunic stay competitive, particularly in identifying areas where product performance could be improved, leading to better product positioning in the marked.

Automation and optimization: I also assisted in the automation and optimization of data queries and processes, for instance, the optimization of a complex query that was used to track days of stock coverage. Optimizing this query improved data processing speed and reduced errors, ensuring that inventory and purchasing decisions were based on accurate, real-time data. This allowed the team to make quicker and more informed decisions about stock levels and restocking.

Cross departmental support: By collaborating with different areas inside the company, I was able to create more targeted and relevant reports that supported each team's unique objectives, ultimately leading to better alignment and more effective decision making across the organization. These interactions were essential for ensuring that the data presented to these teams was relevant and actionable.

Mistakes and areas for improvement

While I was able to contribute to the BI teams, I encountered a few challenges that led to mistakes and areas for improvement.

Inaccurate initial data validation process: At the beginning of my internship, I struggled with ensuring a thorough data validation process, which led to discrepancies in some reports. The issue arose from my limited understanding of the underlying data structures and making assumptions about how certain datasets were organized. To prevent similar mistakes in the future, I would take a more structured approach to data validation by conducting a more in-depth review of the data sources before starting the validation process and working more closely with experienced team members to confirm my understanding of the datasets before making modifications.

Dashboard user experience challenges: When designing dashboards in Qlik, I initially focused more on data presentation than usability, which led to layouts that were not as intuitive as they could be. As a result, some users found it difficult to navigate and interpret the dashboards without additional guidance. This issue arose due to the fast-paced development process, where I did not allocate enough time for user testing and feedback before finalizing the dashboards. To ensure that dashboards are clear, accessible and user friendly, I would implement a structured user feedback process, gathering insights before finalizing anything, conduct usability testing with stakeholders from different department to ensure their needs are met.

Data interpretation discrepancies: During the price elasticity analysis, I encountered a challenge where the same product was interpreted differently depending on the market perspective. The data showed variations in pricing behavior and demand elasticity between Preunic's internal sales trends and the broader market, leading to inconsistencies in conclusions. To minimize the accuracy and consistency of market comparisons, it could develop separate analysis models for Preunic sales data and market wide trends, allowing for more precise insights tailored to each scenario, also to provide detailed documentation explaining how market conditions affect product demand differently in each environment. By adopting these measures, the price elasticity analysis would provide a more structured and context aware view, reducing discrepancies and helping others make data driven pricing decisions with clearer understanding of market dynamics.

My internship experience with the BI team at Preunic was both professionally enriching and intellectually stimulating. The work I performed directly contributed to the organization's decision-making processes, ensuring that reports and dashboards provided accurate, data driven insights to support business strategies. While I faced several challenges throughout the internship, each obstacle served as a valuable learning opportunity, allowing me to refine my technical skills, enhance my analytical thinking, and develop a more structured problem-solving mindset.

Through these experiences, I gained a deeper understanding of data validation, query optimization, and dashboard development, as well as the importance of clear communication and collaboration in a data driven environment. By implementing the solutions and improvements outlined, I believe I can continue to contribute more effectively, delivering even higher quality work in future endeavors.

4. Personal Reflection

Throughout my internship, I had the opportunity to grow both professionally and personally, gaining valuable insights into the role of data driven decision making in a business environment. Through data validation, reporting, and dashboard development, I applied my technical skills and improved how I communicate insights. Each task challenged me to think critically, problem-solve, and ensure that my work directly contributed to the company's objectives.

From a professional standpoint, this experience strengthened my proficiency in SQL, Qlik and data visualization, as well my ability to optimize queries and enhance reporting processes. I learned how to structure and present data in a way that add value to different participant, ensuring that the information provided was both accurate and actionable. In addition, by collaborating with marketing, analysts, and other team members, I improved my ability to adapt to different perspectives and refine my work based on feedback.

Beyond the technical aspects, this internship also helped me gain valuable personal growth. Engaging with professionals from different backgrounds allowed me to build meaningful professional relationship, gain new perspectives, and appreciate the role of teamwork in a communication and collaboration, not only in delivering accurate mentorship I received from my colleagues played a crucial role in my development, reinforcing the value of knowledge sharing and continuous improvement.

Reflecting on my overall experience, this internship has been instrumental in my professional growth, equipping me with technical expertise, analytical problem-solving skills, and a strong ability to collaborate within a data-driven environment. More importantly, it has reinforced my adaptability, resilience, and capacity to contribute meaningfully in professional settings. This experience not only expanded my technical knowledge but also taught me about teamwork, constructive feedback, and continuous learning—skills that will be essential in my career.